

23rd October 2025

Dear Parent/Carer,

Re: October Half Term

As we wrap up a very positive first half term, I would like to thank our students, staff and families for their energy and commitment. From welcoming new Year 7 and Year 12 students to engaging with open events, it has been a positive and purposeful start to the year. We were delighted by the interest shown during Open Week and are incredibly proud of our student performers, presenters and helpers who made the experience memorable for so many prospective families. Thank you, too, to all the parents who joined the parent forums this half term led by our Year Teams, sharing and signposting key events for each Year Group.

Year 11 and Year 13 students have been preparing for their mock exams which take place following the break, and student engagement in our new programme of afterschool tuition sessions has been very positive. To support students complete high quality homework, we continue to provide access to dedicated spaces and resources during break, lunch and after school. Thank you for your continued support in ensuring your child attends the school sessions and for encouraging effective study habits at home.

See what your child will be learning about next half-term on our **subjects** page:

<https://www.spwt.net/secondary/curriculum-subjects>

We thank you for your continued support in helping the school maintain a focused and distraction-free learning environment by ensuring mobile phone, headphones, and smart devices are kept out of sight during the school day. By reinforcing this expectation at home and avoiding contact with your child via mobile during school hours, you help us create a space where our students can fully engage in their learning and personal development.

Alongside their learning in lessons, our students continue to take part in our excellent co-curricular programme. Our newly elected School Council – led by Ibrahim and Asha in Year 13 – will soon begin its work. The Council will focus on working with the school on key priorities as well as leading various social action projects.

Year 7 students have made a fantastic start on their Aspire 7 Programme, a special scheme designed just for them to help demonstrate our three school values, both in the classroom and throughout the school day. Many students have been busy completing challenges, which have been logged onto the school system by our wonderful Year 12 coaches – all 60 of them! Watch this space to see who will come out on top in earning their badges for Community, Aspiration, and Integrity.

Our school community also came together to raise money and donate food to the City Harvest Festival. It has been wonderful to see so many students and staff bringing in food to support families in need. We are incredibly proud of everyone's efforts and would like to thank our families for their generous donations.

Our Sixth Form students have been very excited to have moved into our newly developed VI form facilities; the space includes study areas, a fully resourced IT suite, classrooms and an enrichment zone.

Please help us spread the word regarding our Sixth Form Open Evening which takes place on **Thursday 4th December 2025**. An online booking system is in place to manage visitor numbers. Details and registration can be found on our website: Sixth Form – Apply Now – St Paul's Way.

Our students have continued to be rewarded for demonstrating our school values, with over 21,540-character points just in the last eight weeks. These rewards include over 300 positive phone calls and 650 positive post cards, which are used to reward students who have gone above and beyond in their lesson. All our positive recognition notes are recorded on our Arbor system so these can be viewed on the Arbor parent app. We encourage all parents to download this app so that you can view the positive notes made by teachers.

We encourage you to explore our **Celebrations Newsletter**, which showcases the exciting activities students have participated in this half term via this link: <https://www.spwt.net/viewer/983#sitelive-viewer/>

Parent Communication

Thank you to parents who joined our parent focus groups last year and helped improve our parent communication model as we moved to Arbor Parent App as our main tool of communication with parents. We have launched a very helpful Parent Handbook covering all key information, alongside a weekly Parent Bulletin. We also share information about all school events and deadlines via email and the Parent App. The Parent App also enables all parents to have live access to data about your child's day at school.

Please follow the link here to access the parent handbook: [Parent Handbook - St Paul's Way](#)

Please see the letter here for more details or view [Log into the Parent Portal and the Parent App - Arbor Help Centre \(arbor-education.com\)](#) If you require support to access the Parent App, please visit reception during the school day.

Parent feedback is always valued by the school, and we request that any feedback is sent via the school email admin@spwt.net

We will continue to review the parent/carers experience and will be inviting families to join further focus groups to help shape future improvements. Please do let us know if you will be interested in participating.

Kindly note below the dates for the end of half term and return to school:

- End of half-term: Friday 24th October
- Return to School: Monday 3rd November, arrival 8:30-8:40am.

School Closure and Early Closure Dates – Autumn 2

- Wednesday 3rd December- INSET day
- Thursday 4th December – Early closure for Sixth Form Open Evening: 2:25pm KS3, 2:20pm KS4+5
- Friday 19th December – 12:40pm (End of term)

Please note that the Summer 2 INSET day date has been confirmed as Tuesday 30.6.26.

Wishing all families a restful half term break.

Firdusi Uddin

Head of School, Secondary & Sixth Form

Key Notices

Year Group Staffing, Entrances and Exits

Cohort	Year Team Leader	Student Achievement Coordinator	School Entrance	School Exit
Year 7	Ms Watson	Mr Samuels	Bow Common Lane - Tennis Gate	Bow Common Lane - Tennis Gate
Year 8	Mr Hoque	Ms Abdur-Rahman	Bow Common Lane - Main Gate	Bow Common Lane - Main Gate
Year 9	Ms Ahmed	Mr Gonzalez	Shelmerdine Close	Shelmerdine Close
Year 10	Ms Peters	Mr Ahmed	Shelmerdine Close	Shelmerdine Close
Year 11	Ms Clarke	Mr Ali	Bow Common Lane - Main Gate	Bow Common Lane - Main Gate
Years 12-13	Ms Christou	Ms Marquis & Ms Williams	6 th Form Entrance, Main Building	6 th Form Entrance

- Please send any email queries to admin@spwt.net addressing it for the attention of the relevant leads
- Please note that all key dates for the year can be found on the school website link here [Calendar and Term Dates - St Paul's Way Trust School \(spwt.net\)](http://www.spwt.net/Calendar-and-Term-Dates-St-Pauls-Way-Trust-School-spwt.net)
- Please refer to the weekly parent bulletin for key details.

Safeguarding & Wellbeing

If you have a safeguarding concern or would like some family support, please email safeguarding@spwt.net

For support from the local authority, you can contact the multi-agency support team (MAST)

Phone: 020 7364 5006, Option 2 or 3

Email: MAST@towerhamlets.gov.uk

Website:

https://www.towerhamlets.gov.uk/ignl/health_social_care/children_and_family_care/Multi-Agency-Support-Team-MAST.aspx

Please find the link to our Wellbeing page on the school website, containing useful resources and links to support the mental health and wellbeing of our students: Mental Health and Wellbeing - St Paul's Way (spwt.net) In addition, please see the link to our safeguarding notices page which contains key information and signposting relevant to our students and families in the local context <https://www.spwt.net/about-us/safeguarding>

Uniform

Thank you for ensuring your child has started the new academic year in full uniform. A reminder that any non-uniform items seen will be confiscated. This includes:

- Any non-SPWS jumpers e.g. hoodies and tracksuit tops
- Coats/jackets that are not dark in colour.

In the event of an item being confiscated, parents/carers will be asked to come into school to collect these. The earliest at which this can now happen will be at the end of the next day following confiscation.

Site Safety

Road safety concerns continue with cars entering Shelmerdine close / parking on the double yellow lines on Bow Common Lane. We continue to request that all parents support in keeping the access area to the school safe by not bringing cars onto these roads during drop-off and pick-up times.

Lost Property

Please note that lost property can be checked and collected at the end of each day from the first aid room. At the end of each half-term, we display all lost property in the dining hall for collection; any items not collected are donated to charity. If your child has any lost items, please encourage them to check and collect at the end of the day on Friday.